

The Simple Bangladeshi Foods That Can Fix Your Metabolism

Can't Lose Weight? Your Gut Might Be the Reason. You've tried cutting sugar, joined the gym, maybe even skipped dinner, yet the scale barely moves. The problem might not be your willpower, but your gut. Inside your digestive system live trillions of tiny microorganisms that quietly decide how well your body absorbs nutrients, burns fat, and even regulates your mood. These are your probiotics (good bacteria) that could be the missing link in your journey toward better health and lifestyle. Recent scientific research shows that the gut microbiome, the community of microbes living in our intestines, plays a major role in metabolism and weight regulation. When harmful bacteria outnumber the good ones, our body struggles to digest food efficiently. This imbalance causes bloating, sugar cravings, and stubborn fat that refuses to go away, even with a strict diet. Probiotics restore this balance. They improve digestion, reduce inflammation, and help the body extract energy more efficiently. In fact, certain strains of *Lactobacillus* spp. and *Bifidobacterium* spp. have been shown to help reduce belly fat and waist circumference.



The good news is that you don't need fancy imported capsules to enjoy these benefits. Bangladesh is full of naturally probiotic foods. A bowl of homemade yogurt (doi) is a powerhouse of beneficial bacteria that can cool your body in the summer heat while aiding digestion. Then, laban (the salted yogurt drink) not only helps beat dehydration but also soothes your stomach after spicy meals. Even fermented foods like traditional pickles or rice soaked overnight in water (panta bhaat) can contain natural probiotics that help keep your gut in balance. This is a practice our grandparents knew instinctively long before “gut health” became a global trend.¹

¹ Davis C. D. (2016). The Gut Microbiome and Its Role in Obesity. *Nutrition today*, 51(4), 167–174. <https://doi.org/10.1097/NT.000000000000167>

Probiotics do more than just fix digestion. They strengthen immunity, support mental clarity, and



even contribute to glowing skin. A healthy gut helps absorb vitamins like B12 and K, which is both essential for energy and metabolism. And because the gut produces nearly 90% of the body's serotonin (happy hormone) probiotics can also improve mood and reduce stress-related overeating. So, if you constantly feel tired, bloated, or unable to lose weight despite your efforts, your gut might be trying to send you a message. Feed it right.

Why not start small and add a cup of curd to your lunch. Replace your soft drink with a glass of laban. If you prefer a more modern option, try probiotic yogurt drinks like Yakult or local alternatives available in supermarkets. Within weeks, you'll notice better digestion, lighter energy, and even improvements in sleep and skin texture. Probiotics aren't magic pills rather they're nature's quiet helpers, rebuilding your health from the inside out. ²

So the next time your diet plan feels like it's failing, remember: your gut might just need a little care.

² Nemoto, S., Kubota, T., & Ohno, H. (2023). Exploring body weight-influencing gut microbiota by elucidating the association with diet and host gene expression. *Scientific Reports*, 13(1). <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-023-32411-z>